

FILM REVIEWS

ZINTA AND
BHARDWAJ

VIDESH

Hell on Earth

Director: Deepa Mehta
Starring: Preity Zinta,
Vansh Bhardwaj

RATING ★☆☆☆☆

Why do Bollywood women feel that if they get assaulted by men, wear no make-up and speak very slowly in movies directed by NRIs, they will be taken seriously? You wonder when you watch Preity Zinta being beaten to pulp virtually throughout Deepa Mehta's excruciating film, and then suffer the worse fate of imagining she is sleeping with a snake. Inspired partly by Girish Karnad's *Nagamandala*, the film is on its surest footing when it builds the terror that Zinta faces daily. The in-laws watch Gurbani on TV while her husband

smashes her into a mirror, bed and every other object in their bedroom; the home is cramped; and the mother-in-law lands up in the honeymoon suite. Immigrant life in Canada is shown to be hell on earth—the in-laws go to a shopping mall thrice a week to rent out the bedrooms; women work drudge jobs to support their families; and the requests for citizen sponsorships never seem to stop. But between Zinta's Jamaican friend's magic root and her own sexual experiments with the imaginary snake man, this is a mess of a movie. *by Kaveree Bamzai*

MUSIC REVIEW

The Heat of Fusion



GROUNDNED
IN SPACE
EMI
Rs 195

Sometimes it is difficult for music bands to develop alternative Indian sounds and then keep reinventing themselves to

sound innovative with every song. But Advaita has been an exception. The group was formed in 2004 and gradually grew, imbibing various musical cultures. And they constantly had the urge to create something new and rediscover different facets of music. The debut album has 10 songs. "It was a spiritual quest," says Suhail Yusuf Khan who plays the sarangi and sings in the band. The songs have a mix of western and Indian classical music with a sprinkling of *taans* and *alaap*. The songs speak to you and compel you to introspect. Listen to experience it.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

AADEKHEN ZARA

Freeze Frame

Director: Jehangir Surti
Starring: Neil Nitin Mukesh,
Bipasha Basu

RATING ★★☆☆☆

What happens when Big Hair Basu meets Rosy Cheeks Mukesh? A foxy encounter involving a camera that captures the future, car chases in Bangkok, and sizzling dances on elevated pedestals? Almost. Think wannabe *Race* and mix it with wannabe *Johnny Gaddar*. Basu plays a fiercely independent young woman in Mumbai who meets Mukesh, a

charming but down-at-heel James Hadley Chase loser looking for a quick buck. Mukesh inherits a camera that makes his fortune and sets him up for a series of odd meetings with a very fierce looking Rahul Dev. The film almost takes off, until several laughable events happen. Sophie "Baby Doll" Chaudhry turns up as a R&AW agent, Big Hair-Rosy Cheeks take time out to dance with beer-drinking Thais even as death stares them in the face, and an inherited watch ends up as a time machine. Still there's enough excitement while the fair haired pink-lipped Mr Mukesh is making money shooting lottery tickets, race courses and stock market tickers. For special effects, there are Ms Basu's stringy tops, tiny bottoms and big attitude. *-KB*

BASU (L) AND
MUKESH